

Parliamentarian uniform

The New Model Army, formed in 1645 by Parliament, was England's first professional army. The foot regiments, comprised of pikemen and musketeers, were provided with the distinctive red tunic shown here.

red coat was the only uniform item officially issued to the New Model Army

soldiers were often issued swords, also called tucks

woolen breeches



colored bow, which was used to fasten breeches

Foiled royalist plot

This propaganda print was probably intended for popular consumption. It is a graphic account of the "Malignants' plot" against Parliament that was unearthed on May 31, 1643.



The plan is to arrest the leading parliamentarians, including their (Puritan) leader John Pym, along with two members of the House of Lords.

The conspirators are hanged at the Tyburn gallows. Responding to the Covenant, the King issues a proclamation making all who support it guilty of treason. The die is cast.

After the fall of Oxford in 1646, Charles's surrender to the Scots at Newark marked the end of the first civil war.

Parliament's supporters now split into those who wanted to share power with the king, and a more radical group, supported by the army generals, that wanted a republic. Despite his confinement, Charles continued to bargain with various parties, finally making a deal with the Scots to adopt Presbyterianism (their system of church government) in England in return for their support. The royalists rose again in July 1648 and the Scots invaded England. The New Model Army (see caption, left) easily suppressed these uprisings before crushing the Scots at Preston. They then marched on Parliament and dismissed most of its members. The 58 who remained—known as the Rump Parliament—were ordered to set up a High Court to try the king for treason. Charles I was found guilty and beheaded on January 30, 1649. This was truly revolutionary; monarchs had been deposed or killed before, but never legally executed. Parliament now abolished the monarchy and the House of Lords, declaring England a republic or "Commonwealth."

The Lord Protector

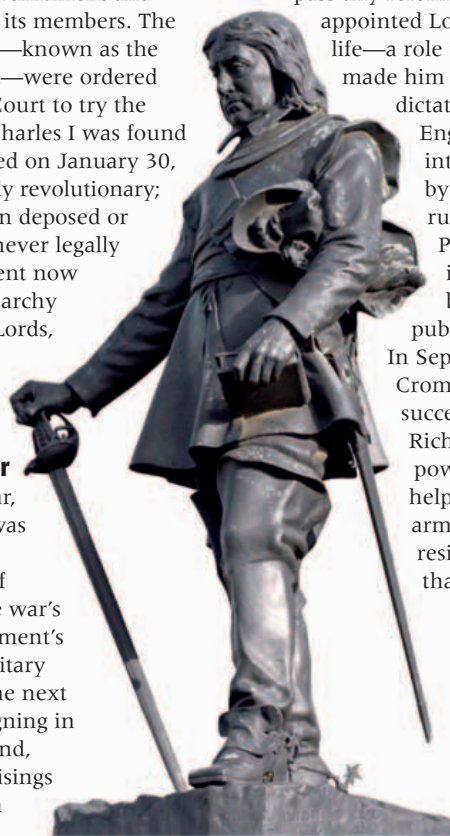
Before the civil war, Oliver Cromwell was a landowner and Puritan Member of Parliament. By the war's end, he was Parliament's most powerful military leader. He spent the next two years campaigning in Scotland and Ireland, crushing local uprisings and bringing them

**Charles I's death warrant**

On January 29, 1649, Charles I was found guilty of being a traitor. His death warrant, shown here, is endorsed by many signatures, including that of Oliver Cromwell.

firmly under English control. His defeat of a Scottish army loyal to Charles I's son (later Charles II) at Worcester in 1651 finally brought an end to the civil war. In 1653, Cromwell dismissed the Rump Parliament, unhappy at its failure to pass any reforms. After being appointed Lord Protector for life—a role that effectively made him a military

dictator—he divided England and Wales into 10 districts ruled by army generals. His rule, based on strict Puritan principles, included the banning of most public entertainments. In September 1658, Cromwell died and was succeeded by his son Richard. With no power base, he was helpless against the army generals and resigned after less than a year.

**Statue of Cromwell**

A devout military leader and shrewd politician, Oliver Cromwell became king in all but name.

AFTER

In 1660 the monarchy was reinstated to restore national unity. A second revolution to restore Protestantism was followed by a Bill of Rights (1689) that marked the start of a more limited, constitutional monarchy.

THE RESTORATION

After Cromwell's death, the throne was offered to Charles II on the condition that he supported religious toleration and pardoned those who had fought his father. Puritan rules were swiftly dropped—theaters and music halls reopened, and public festivals, such as Christmas, were restored. Nell Gwyn, a former orange-seller turned actress, became one of the king's most popular mistresses.



NELL GWYN

THOMAS HOBBES

Hobbes, one of England's most influential political thinkers, lived through the bloodshed of the civil war. His book *Leviathan*, published in 1651, advocates strong government at the expense of personal freedom, arguing that humankind's natural state is one of unending conflict.

THE "GLORIOUS REVOLUTION"

The openly Catholic James II, who succeeded Charles II in 1685, alienated his subjects by placing religion above politics. His advisers secretly invited the Dutch Protestant prince, William of Orange, to take over the throne in 1688.

In response to John Pym's report on the royal plot, the Commons accepts the imposition of a vow of support for Parliament known as "the Covenant," which is sent around the country as a test of loyalty. On June 15 the City of London observes a day of Thanksgiving to celebrate the prevention of this "wicked plot."